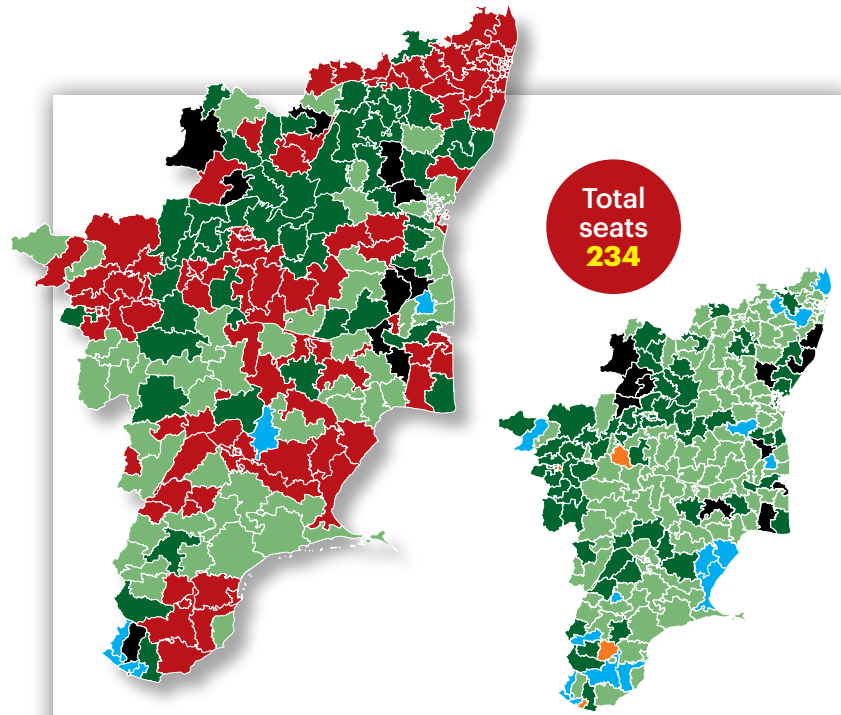
SUPERSTAR'S STUNNING SWEEP

ACTOR-TURNED-POLITICIAN VIJAY CONFOUNDS ALL EXPECTATIONS AS HIS TAMILAGA VETTRI KAZHAGAM BECOMES THE SINGLE LARGEST PARTY, LEAVING THE STATE'S TWO DRAVIDIAN TITANS IN DISARRAY

By Kavitha Muralidharan

Appadi podu, podu (Do it that way).... On May 4, as early leads came in, Tamil Nadu had only one song on its lips, the electric mass anthem from the 2004 superhit *Ghilli*, starring Vijay and Trisha Krishnan. And why not, since the superstar's two-year-old party, the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), was looking like it was running away with the election. By the end of the day, Vijay's TVK emerged as the single largest party with 108 seats, just 10 short of a majority in the 234-member assembly. The verdict disrupted five decades of dominance by the Dravidian majors, the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK). The result instantly triggered comparisons between Vijay and the late actor and chief minister M.G. Ramachandran (MGR). But it's early days yet. Suffice it to say that the 2026 election produced one of the most significant realignments of Tamil Nadu's popular politics in decades.

Of the other parties, the DMK trailed with 59 seats while the AIADMK secured 47. The political disruption aside, the central question now is not merely how Vijay won, but how a toddler party upended such entrenched political entities within two years of entering electoral politics. A major factor appears to have been the consolidation of



	DMK	AIADMK			
2026	59 (24.3%)	47 (21.2%)	2021	DMK 133 (37.7%)	AIADMK 66 (33.3%)
TVK 108 (34.9%)	Cong. 5 (3.4%)	Others 8 (2.3%)	BJP 4 (2.6%)	Cong. 18 (4.3%)	Others 13 (6.7%)

Vote share in ()

The result triggered comparisons between Vijay and the late actor and chief minister M.G. Ramachandran (MGR) in the '70s, but it's early days yet